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One square. Six letters.

Before reading an opinion, establish what is actually proposed.

Editor's verified briefing

Seabreeze Council is considering a **six-Friday trial** at Seabreeze Square. Up to **eight food trucks** could operate from **5:00 pm to 8:00 pm**. The draft includes **waste stations**, an **accessible path** and a **review after the trial**.

The briefing does not prove future noise, profit, parking failure, litter, community renewal or universal support.

Five fingerprints of bias

1. **Loaded evaluation** praises, shames or alarms.
2. **Sweeping generalisation** speaks for everyone.
3. **Assumed motive** claims to know why people act.
4. **Omission** hides relevant detail.
5. **Unsupported certainty** treats a prediction as fact.

Stop the Friday Food-Truck Circus

A

MARINA VALE, SQUARE RESIDENT

Seabreeze Square is about to be surrendered to a noisy food-truck circus. Reckless councillors appear more interested in colourful photographs than in the people who actually live here. Every resident knows that eight engines, queues and music will destroy the quiet of Friday evenings.

The council calls this a six-week trial, but we all know what that means: once the trucks invade, they will never leave. Parking will become impossible, rubbish will tumble through the streets and local cafes will be abandoned. Nobody asked ordinary residents whether we wanted our square turned into a dining yard.

Council must reject this foolish scheme before permanent damage is done. Either it protects the square now or admits that visitors matter more than residents.

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The loud pull

Opposite positions can use the same biased techniques.

Let the Town Wake Up

THEO GRANT, HOSPITALITY STUDENT

At last, somebody has offered to rescue our lifeless town centre. Food trucks will fill Seabreeze Square with colour, flavour and laughter. Only the usual whining few could oppose an idea this brilliant.

Everyone knows the square is completely empty on Friday nights. The trial will bring families together, save struggling businesses and give young people a reason to stay in town. Critics complain about parking because they fear any change they did not invent themselves.

There are only two choices: support the trucks or accept a dead town centre. Council should ignore the selfish complainers and approve the full trial immediately.

B

Parking First, Please

RAVI SINGH, NEARBY RESIDENT

The proposed food-truck trial should not proceed at Seabreeze Square until council solves the parking problem. On each trial evening, twelve spaces beside the square would be unavailable for ordinary vehicles. Those spaces are used by residents and customers of nearby shops.

Removing them will push cars into surrounding streets and make access difficult. The result will be inconvenience for residents and fewer customers for existing businesses. Council should choose another location before approving the trial.

A lively evening program may be worthwhile, but parking must come first.

C

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The quiet pull

Calm wording can still select, omit and predict beyond the evidence.

A Chance for Young People D

LENA CHO, YOUTH COMMITTEE MEMBER

Seabreeze needs more places where young people and families can spend time together. A Friday food-truck trial would give the square a welcoming purpose after many shops close for the day. At our youth committee meeting, several students said they would attend with friends or family.

The proposal offers different foods and a reason to meet in a public place. Events like this create connection, support new vendors and help young people feel that the town includes them. Many families will enjoy an affordable evening close to home.

Council should approve the trial and show that young residents' ideas matter.

Trial It, Measure It, Adjust It E

MARA ELLIS, COMMUNITY VOLUNTEER

The food-truck proposal could bring new activity to Seabreeze Square, but nearby residents are reasonable to ask about noise, parking and waste. The draft is a six-Friday trial from 5:00 pm to 8:00 pm, not a permanent program, and it caps attendance at eight vendors.

Council should proceed only with the stated accessible path and waste stations in place. During the trial it should record complaints, litter, attendance, parking pressure and feedback from nearby businesses. These measures will not tell us whether every person likes the event, but they will provide better local evidence than confident predictions from either side.

I support the trial because it is limited and reviewable. If the evidence shows unacceptable problems, council should change the hours, reduce vendor numbers or choose another location.

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Balanced and still persuasive

A fair writer can acknowledge limits and recommend a clear action.

Protect the Square While Testing the Idea

OWEN PARK, ACCESS ADVOCATE

Supporters are right that a shared evening event may help people gather, while residents are right that a public square must remain accessible and manageable. The current proposal includes an accessible path and a later review, but it does not yet explain how the path will be monitored when queues form.

Council should begin with four trucks on the first two Fridays, mark the accessible route clearly and station a marshal at the busiest crossing. It should then publish what it observed before increasing the number of vendors. This smaller start would not remove every risk, but it would test the idea without pretending that support or concern is unreasonable.

A careful trial can welcome new activity and protect ordinary use of the square.

F

Balanced-language field guide

Attribute The writer argues...

Concede Residents may reasonably...

Qualify may, could, if...

Set a boundary The proposal does not yet show...

Recommend Council should trial, measure and review...

Editorial challenge: preserve each real position while removing loaded, sweeping and mind-reading language.